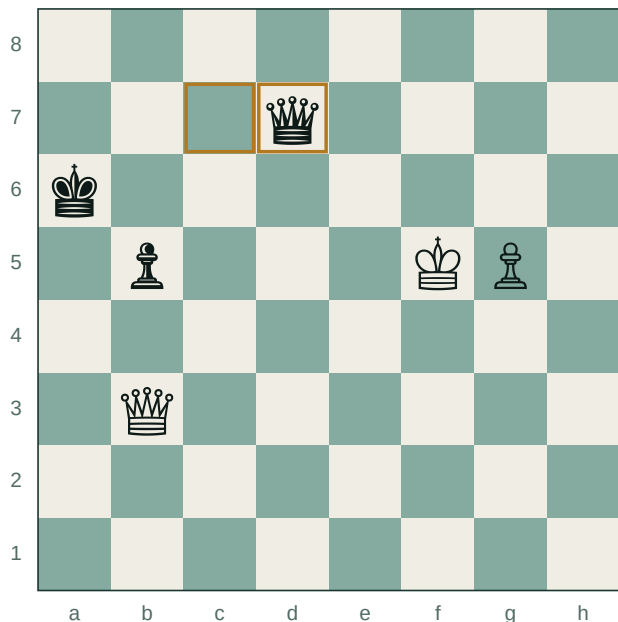


Promotion combinations: White, move 74

Promotion combinations

White to move



Previous move: 73...Qd7+. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

74. Qe6+ Qxe6+ 75. Kxe6 b4 76. g6 b3 77. g7 b2 78. g8=Q

74.Qe6+ Check restricts Black to 6 legal replies here. From e6 it attacks king on a6 and queen on d7. Recorded reply: **74...Qxe6+**.

75.Kxe6 The king captures the queen on e6. Recorded reply: **75...b4**.

76.g6 The pawn moves from g5 to g6. Recorded reply: **76...b3**.

77.g7 The pawn moves from g6 to g7. Recorded reply: **77...b2**.

78.g8=Q The pawn moves from g7 to g8. The pawn becomes a queen.

At the end, nominal material is White 9 / Black 1 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +8. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +8: the balance goes from +0 to +8. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

Always inspect stalemate and underpromotion resources. A queen is usually strongest, but the exact position determines the choice.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An advanced pawn can turn a tactical sequence into a new queen or another useful piece. Promotion may occur with capture or check, and the choice of piece can change the outcome.

HOW TO LOOK

Calculate the pawn's route, the safety of the promotion square, and whether the new piece can survive or give a decisive check.

The defending king is on a6. Geometrically undefended: queen on d7. Check for tactical protection.